



Photographs by MANDAR DEODHAR

Schauna Chauhan, *47*
CEO, Parle Agro
Nadia Chauhan, *37*
Joint MD and CMO, Parle Agro

LEGACY BUILDERS

SCHAUNA CHAUHAN, THE ELDEST DAUGHTER of Parle Agro founder Prakash Chauhan, took over as CEO in 2006, and she has transformed the home-grown food processing company into a Rs 8,000 crore giant with food brands such as Frooti, Appy and Bailey competing with those from the likes of PepsiCo.

The company now sources 96 per cent of materials domestically, a fact that Schauna describes as Parle Agro's most significant achievement to date. "It shows our commitment to supporting local businesses and the national economy through a focused effort."

Currently, what keeps her busy is balancing growth with sustainability, which she calls "one of the toughest challenges". It started when the plastic straw ban came into effect and has since evolved into a mission to integrate green initiatives into every growth strategy. The supply chain has been reworked to source sustainable material, production processes have been fine-tuned to minimise wastage, reduce fuel emissions and reuse water, in addition to transitioning to more ecofriendly processes. Parle Agro now also has a network of aggregators to collect plastic (including PET waste) for recycling.

The next big aim, says Nadia, the youngest of the three sisters, is to make Parle Agro a Rs 20,000 crore company by 2030. Responsible for sales and marketing, distribution, automation and R&D, she says, "My focus is on scaling up, whether it's distribution, marketing or talent. From every perspective, we are looking at a massive increase in capability within the organisation."

Nadia was just 17 when she joined the company in 2003. Since then, passionate about product diversification, she has helped launch not only new products but also new categories. Their sparkling fruit-flavoured drink Appy Fizz and dairy brand Smoodh are two such instances. A key achievement was the sales and distribution transformation in 2010. "It enabled us to scale our outlet base from 300,000 to over 2 million," says Nadia.

Both sisters see their father as a mentor and try to emulate his business thinking. Concerning future plans, Schauna is looking to turn their manufacturing units into 'smart factories' to harness the power of IoT devices and data analytics. Nadia is excited that soon after, there will be expansions into new product categories. ■

–Sonal Khetarpal

STARTING EARLY

"A headstart is invaluable; you can never start too early" *-Schauna*

"I keep my mind open to be inspired by the smallest things in life" *-Nadia*

PETCETERA
Both sisters are partial to their furry friends. Nadia has horses and dogs while Schauna used to own a bull mastiff, Brando

ACCOMPLISHMENT
The Chauhan sisters have in two decades transformed the Parle Agro brand into an Rs 8,000 crore FMCG behemoth